

VER. 26.1

Authenticity

Neck Protections

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1. Implementation

The document has been created and approved by the General Assembly of 09.11.2024.
The document and its rules have been implemented since the 2025 season.

2. Definition

"**Neck protection**" is the term to describe all historical and adapted protection for neck, shoulders and throat. Those protections are mandatory to ensure the safety of competitors.

Neck protection can be worn upon the Aventail or not, depending on the type of protection.

Types of Neck protection:

- **Neck shield**
  Metal plates that replicate the shape of a heater shield. It is allowed to be worn upon the Aventail.

- **Lobster tail**
  Articulated metal plates designed as a lobster tail. It is allowed to be worn upon the Aventail.

- **Gorget**
  A gorget is a plate protection that covers the neck, shoulders and throat. It is allowed to be visible and worn with the proper armor set.

- **Concealed neck plates**
  Metal plates directly sewn to the gambeson or the Aventail. They must be hidden under the Aventail.

3. General Requirements

All types of Neck protection must respect the following requirements:

- be based on historical sources if they are visible,
- be concealed if they are not based on historical sources,
- be firmly attached to prevent any breakage and maintain a high level of protection in any case.

Any metal part of the Neck protection must conform to the "*Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations"* document.

Any textile or leather part of the Neck protection must conform to the "*Textiles and Leather"* document.

4. Recommendations

It is recommended to wear a Neck protection sewn to your gambeson. This protection covers your neck no matter the position of your helmet (bent or twisted during wrestling).

Neck protection relying on your Aventail can be damaged during fights and may be removed if not firmly attached to the Aventail. It is recommended to ensure those Neck protections are well attached and will not be removed easily.

5. Neck shield

5.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Miniatures sometimes display a small shield attached to the Aventail, mainly during the 14th century. Those shields were supposed to show the heraldry of the wearer. Thus, as Neck protection is mandatory in our sport, such neck shields are allowed to be worn on the Aventail.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.



Book of Hours - 1320 - The Netherlands

5.2. Specific Requirements

Neck shield:

- must conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above),
- can be worn upon the Aventail. It must be firmly attached to the Aventail,
- must have a shape inspired by the heater shield,
- cannot exceed 15x17 cm,
- can be painted,
- if painted, must conform to the "*Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations"* document.

5.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions









5.4. Examples of Denied Reproductions

Oversized neck shield, it risks being ripped off during wrestling.



Round shape is not allowed, it must be concealed under the Aventail.



Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

6. Lobster tail

6.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Lobster tail is a lobster-shape Neck protection made of articulated metal plates. It is depicted in manuscript and art from the late 14th century to the 15th century.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.



Paduan Bible - 1400 - Italy



"Le Livre et le vraye hystoire du bon roy Alixandre" - 1400/1420 - France



Altar of St James, Pistoia - 1380/1400 - Italy

6.2. Specific Requirements

Lobster tail:

- must conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above),
- can be worn upon the Aventail. It must be firmly attached to the Aventail,
- cannot be painted if they are worn upon the Aventail,
- must be articulated and consist of at least 3 parts,
- cannot exceed 15 x 25 cm.

6.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions



Picture from Gohurt ©

6.4. Examples of Denied Reproductions

Oversized



Picture from The Medieval Things ©

7. Gorget

7.1. Historical Sources and Datation

A gorget was a type of Neck protection worn over the neck, clavicles, and shoulders. It evolved from earlier forms of neck defenses, which often relied on chainmail or padded fabrics like the Aventail.

By the late 15th century, as plate armor became more refined, the gorget emerged as a key piece of protection for the throat and neck, made primarily from steel plates. Gorgets were most common in the 16th century but evidence exists of gorgets and plate collars.

They are **Approved** for **15th century armors**.

They are **Denied** for **14th century** and **Transitional armors**.





Wade Allen collection - 1510 - Italy

7.2. Specific Requirements

Gorget must:

- conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above),
- be constructed from plates,
- cover the clavicles and back of the neck. The throat should have a low profile, be articulated or otherwise fitted in such a way that it doesn't choke the wearer when their head is tilted forward.
- be worn with appropriate armor styles and match historical sources in function and appearance.

7.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions



Picture from The Medieval Things ©

8. Concealed neck plates

8.1. Historical Sources and Datation

There are no historical sources nor datation for such armor elements.

Nevertheless, it is **Approved** to reinforce your neck armor with concealed plates.

8.2. Specific Requirements

Concealed neck plates must:

- conform to the general requirements (see Section 3 above).
- be made of metal.
- be hidden under the Aventail.
- be firmly attached.
- be smooth with no sharp edges.

It is recommended to paint concealed neck plates with anti rust paint. Such paint must be a neutral color (grey, black) and do not interfere with the aesthetic of the armor.

8.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions









Pictures from Medieval Extreme ©

8.4. Examples of Denied Reproductions

Metal plates visible







Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

9. Changelog

Below, we will keep track of all the changes made over the lifetime of this document. This way, all our members can see how the documents are changing over time.

January - 2026 (V. 26.1)
Formatting redone for consistency and readability. Except points listed below, no content changes.
Add: “1. Implementation” (and subsequent modification of all Title numbers in the document)
Clarification:
- Split of “1. Definition and general requirements” in “2. Definition and description” and “3. General Requirements”. **This split doesn’t have an impact on the content of the rules.**

February-2025 (V2025.02)
- formatting: overall grammar and formatting
- add: 4.1 They are denied for 14th century and Transitional armors

December-2024: -Add
Document has been created